

64 Before and after

English uses the past perfect with the past simple to talk about two or more events that happened at different times in the past.

⚙️ **New language** Past perfect and past simple

🔤 **Vocabulary** Visual arts

🧑 **New skill** Describing sequences of past events

64.1 KEY LANGUAGE PAST PERFECT AND PAST SIMPLE

The past simple describes the event that is closest to the time of speaking.

The past perfect describes an event further back in the past.

PAST PERFECT
The train **had left** before we **arrived** at the station.



8:10PM



8:20PM

NOW



64.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES PAST PERFECT AND PAST SIMPLE

I **knocked** on Pablo's door, but he **had** already **gone** to work.



7:00AM



7:30AM

NOW

The traffic **was** bad because a car **had broken down** on the road.



2:30PM



3:00PM

NOW

